

Together, we can fight for truth. Start by sharing this zine!

"A lie can travel halfway around the world while the truth is still putting on its shoes."
- Jonathan Swift

How it spreads.

* Social media

* Fake news webpages

* Misleading memes or out of context content

* Bot accounts & Troll farms

* Psychological tactics using fear, emotional manipulation & echo chambers*



* Echo chamber - an environment where a person encounters info or opinions that reflect & reinforce their own.

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Understanding & Fighting Disinformation

The Truth About Lies:

Educational Resources:

* Books.

The Misinformation Age: How False Beliefs Spread by Cailin O'Connor & James Owen Weatherall

Weapons of Math Destruction by Cathy O'Neil

* Documentaries.
The Social Dilemma (Netflix)

* After Truth:

Disinformation & the Cost of Fake News (HBO)

* Websites.

Factcheck.org

Factcheck.com

* Snopes

* Media Bias

11 organizations

• Advocate for algorithms to flag or reduce disinformation on platforms

• Support fact-checking

• Support real journalism

* Tech - Solutions *

• Educate friends & family about media literacy

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How to Spot Disinformation:

* Red Flags *

• Emotional language

• Lack of credible sources

• Photos or videos that seem edited or out of context

* Fact-checking Tools *

• Websites like Snopes, PolitiFact, & Factcheck

• Reverse image source tools (Google, TinEye)

* Check sources *

• Look for reliable, well-sourced reporting

* Recognize manipulation tactics *

• Fear-mongering

• Scapegoating

• Misquoting experts

* Diversify your news intake!!! *

Intake!!! *

Intake!!! *

Intake!!! *

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• Reproductive Rights. Lies about abortion laws & fear-based narratives put women at risk.

• Marginalized communities

• LGBTQ+ people, women, & racial minorities are often targeted with harmful, fear-based lies.

• Truth & Journalism. Fake news weakens trust in real journalism & makes it hard for people to find reliable information.

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- * Election Lies & Jan 6 (2021) *
- Trumps "Stop the Steal" disinformation campaign fueled the Capitol attack, showing how false claims can incite violence.
- * "Grooming" Narrative Against LGBTQ+ People *
- Far-right groups falsely claim LGBTQ+ individuals & even teachers are "grooming" children, fueling hate & violence.

Who Benefits?

- Corporations & Industry Lobbyists
 - Governments & Political Actors
 - Social Media Companies & News Outlets
 - Cybercriminals & Manipulators
 - Religious & Ideological groups
- Why Does it Work?
- People trust what aligns with their beliefs
 - Fear spreads faster than facts
 - Corporations & big money depend on public confusion



- * Climate Denial For Profit *
- Fossil Fuel companies spread doubt about climate change for decades to delay regulations & maximize profits.

'Disinformation' In Action:

- * Covid-19 "cures" *
- False claims about drinking bleach, ivermectin, & hydroxychloroquine spread rapidly, leading to hospitalizations & deaths.

Media Literacy Basics:

- Questions to ask yourself when reading the news:
1. Who is the source? Are they credible?
 2. What's their bias or motivation?
 3. Are there other sources reporting this story?
 4. Does it appeal to emotion over evidence?

- Advocacy & Action
- * Advocate for stronger policies to regulate false advertising & disinformation online!
 - * Support independent journalism!!!!
 - * Push for our schools to teach media literacy!
- Organizations like First Draft, Media Matters, & PenAmerica are already fighting the good fight! *
- Check them out! *

What is Disinformation?

- * Disinformation is FALSE information spread intentionally to deceive.
- * Differs from misinformation which is false information spread without intent to deceive.
- * Examples include political propaganda, AI-generated fake news, health misinformation, corporate lies, fake flyers & brochures, etc.

- The Impact of Disinformation:
- Democracy & Elections. False claims manipulate voters, suppress turnout, & erode trust in fair elections.
 - Public Health. Vaccine misinformation, fake cures, & public health lies put lives at risk.
 - The Environment. Climate denial delays action while our planet suffers & corporations profit.

Further Reading:

- This Election Year, Fighting misinformation is messier and more important than ever - on www.apa.org
- The Climate Deception Dossier - on www.ucsusa.org
- Exxon Disputed Climate Findings for Years. Its Scientists Knew Better - on news.harvard.edu
- Vaccine Misinformation Outpaces Efforts to Counter It - on www.publichealth.columbia.edu